

Spotty scanner

Hi Vinit,
The August issue with the scanner and OCR software test was just the thing I was waiting for. However, the test team should have also covered the build quality of the scanners. I bought a Umax 4400 after reading your test, but the glass seemed to have some stains on the inside. This could only be seen when the lamp was switched on. I returned the piece and got another one, but this one has the marks as well, though not as bad. Did your test team notice this?

Gerard
Via e-mail

Hi Gerard,

No, the Umax 4400 scanner we received didn't have any stains or marks on it. Scanners are quite delicate and are prone to damage during transportation and handling and we did receive a number of broken scanners for our test. You should consider exchanging your scanner till you are satisfied, as any stains on the glass surface might adversely affect the scan quality.

digit

Lagging behind

Dear Vinit,
I'm quite satisfied with Digit as it has really great content and I've gained a lot of knowledge from it. But why doesn't Digit keep its readers abreast about the latest international products and their prices, apart from those that are available locally? Not only would we be aware of what we're missing out on, but could also procure the products through someone else. This would be one more step towards making Digit a truly international magazine.

Sophia Ajaz
Via e-mail

Dear Sophia,

Digit is an international class technology magazine for India. Only a select handful of our readers can actually purchase products from abroad by buying them online or ordering them through relatives and friends. Also, there would be innumerable delays in sourcing these 'just released' products from outside India for testing. Besides, Indian vendors are actively working towards reducing the time lag between international and Indian release dates, with some products being released concurrently worldwide. Hence, we only review and test products that are readily available in the Indian market or those which a majority of our readers would have access to, such as new software that can be downloaded from the Net.

digit

Short Bytes

Rock on

Hi Vinit,
I have always skipped the music section of Surge, because I don't like techno and trance, but the Indian rock collection on the August 2002 Playware CD was fantastic.

Vishal

Via e-mail

Hi Vishal,
Indian rock bands have definitely come of age. And the most amazing thing is that these bands created the music on their PCs!

Dr Digit

Dear Digit,
You will be surprised to know how popular Digit has become in the doctors' community, especially amongst medical students and new doctors like me. There are so many of us who wish to be current with our knowledge of the tech world and at the same time want it to be simple. Digit is truly a technology magazine for the common man.

Manoj Khemani

Via e-mail

Working smart

Dear Digit,
I often have to send my presentations to clients, but am not too sure whether they have PowerPoint on their machines. Is it possible to send my presentations created in PowerPoint XP in a format that will enable the receiver to view it without any problems such as missing fonts, slide transitions, etc?

G. Seth
Via e-mail

Dear Mr Seth,

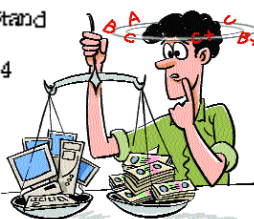
We receive hundreds of similar mail every month asking for solutions to common problems faced by people working in a modern office. So we've decided to compile the most frequently asked questions and present them to our readers in a special edition of this month's Tips & Tricks titled Smart@work. For an answer to your particular question, turn to page 114.

digit

Need for speed

Dear Vinit,
I don't understand one thing: the Intel Pentium 4 2.53 GHz reviewed in August 2002 is faster than Pentium 4 2.4 GHz, but you have awarded it a B+ rating against the A- rating given to the latter. All the features are the same in both, except for the clock speed.

Sri Harish
Via e-mail



digit

Dear Sri,

We take various parameters into account while reviewing a product such as performance, features, build quality and value for money. Even though the Pentium 4 2.53 GHz is faster than the P4 2.4 GHz (and its performance scores reflect this), it loses out heavily when it comes to value for money. This results in a lower overall score and grade for the faster albeit pricier processor.

Send your letters marked 'Readers Letters' to the Digit office:
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Goof Ups

- In the scanner comparison test (August 2002), we've incorrectly mentioned that the HP Scanjet 5400C, 5470C and Microtek ScanMaker X12USL (pg 60, features table) do not have removable lids.
- Several readers have complained that the Java 2 Development Kit (Mindware CD, August 2002) was corrupted. We'll provide a fresh installation with the October issue.
- In the printer comparison test (July 2002) we've incorrectly mentioned that the HP Deskjet 845C (pg 55, features table) has a parallel port.

Notice any goof-ups? Write to
goof@jasubhai.com